GRADE 7 ELA QUESTION BANK

Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

150 multiple-choice questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Instructions: Choose the best answer for each question. The difficulty levels are kept in separate blocks: Easy questions 1–50, Medium questions 51–100, and Hard questions 101–150. The answer key appears at the end.

EASY QUESTIONS (1–50)

Figurative Language and Comparison

1. In the line “The moon was a silver coin,” which device is used?

A. Simile
B. Onomatopoeia
C. Alliteration
D. Metaphor

2. “The leaves danced in the breeze” gives leaves a human action. Which device is this?

A. Symbolism
B. Hyperbole
C. Personification
D. Rhyme

3. Which phrase is a simile?

A. The clouds marched
B. Bright as a button
C. Her voice was music
D. The hallway was a river

4. Which word is an example of onomatopoeia?

A. Golden
B. Buzz
C. Whisper
D. Gentle

5. Which phrase appeals most directly to the sense of smell?

A. A smoky, cinnamon scent
B. A distant bell
C. A rough stone
D. A sour lemon

6. Which pair of words alliterates?

A. green field
B. warm bread
C. blue river
D. silent stars

7. Which line contains end rhyme?

A. The wind moved through the trees
B. A bright light filled the room
C. The cat sat by the gate / And watched until it was late
D. The river ran swiftly

8. What is the speaker in a poem?

A. The reader's friend
B. The poem's title
C. The voice that speaks in the poem
D. The person who prints the book

9. Which phrase uses imagery?

A. A place was there
B. The cold rain tapped my cheeks
C. I thought about it
D. It happened yesterday

10. What is a stanza?

A. A group of lines in a poem
B. The final punctuation mark
C. The poem's author
D. A word that rhymes

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

11. “I waited a million years” is an example of—

A. rhyme
B. metaphor
C. alliteration
D. hyperbole

12. Which word best describes a poem's mood?

A. The writer's full name
B. The page size
C. The number of lines
D. The feeling it creates for readers

13. Which line contains a metaphor?

A. The rain went plip-plop
B. The bird flew like a kite
C. Her backpack was a mountain
D. The sun smiled at us

14. Which word most clearly suggests a joyful tone?

A. gloomy
B. delighted
C. bitter
D. mournful

15. Which pair of words has the clearest rhyme?

A. light / night
B. warm / wind
C. tree / stone
D. bird / bright

16. Which line uses personification?

A. The clock glared at me
B. The clock showed six
C. The clock stood on a shelf
D. The clock had black hands

17. Which detail appeals to touch?

A. A trumpet blast
B. A lemon's sharp taste
C. A rose's scent
D. A velvet-soft blanket

18. What is the theme of a poem most likely to express?

A. The number of stanzas
B. The place where it was printed
C. A message or insight about life
D. A list of rhyming words

19. Which phrase is an example of alliteration?

A. a quiet pond
B. wild winds whistle
C. under the bridge
D. over the hill

20. Which line contains a simile?

A. The river whispered
B. The snow fell like feathers
C. My feet were ice
D. The classroom was a zoo

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

21. What is rhyme?

A. The repetition of similar ending sounds
B. A comparison using like or as
C. A group of lines
D. An exaggerated statement

22. Which line uses sound words to imitate an action?

A. Dinner was ready.
B. The kitchen was warm.
C. The pan was shiny.
D. Clang! The pan hit the floor.

23. Which image is primarily visual?

A. A sharp whistle
B. The scent of pine
C. A red kite above the rooftops
D. A bitter sip

24. Which word has a negative connotation?

A. slender
B. determined
C. scrawny
D. confident

25. What is the tone of a poem?

A. The number of syllables in every line
B. The speaker's attitude toward the subject
C. The poem's rhyme scheme only
D. The reader's physical location

26. Which line uses a metaphor to describe time?

A. Time is a thief
B. Time ticked loudly
C. Time moved like a train
D. Time passed yesterday

27. Which is an example of sensory language?

A. The soup was served
B. The soup was on the table
C. The soup belonged to Ana
D. The soup tasted salty and smoky

28. What is a line break?

A. A missing word
B. The title's final letter
C. A broken rhyme
D. The point where one poetic line ends and another begins

29. Which phrase suggests a peaceful mood?

A. shattered glass in darkness
B. thunder cracking overhead
C. soft waves under a pale moon
D. sirens screaming nearby

30. Which line includes a sound device based on repeated beginning consonants?

A. Clouds crossed the sky
B. Peter packed purple pears
C. The day grew long
D. The river was deep

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

31. Which statement about a poem's title is most reasonable?

A. It can give clues about the subject or meaning
B. It never matters to interpretation
C. It must rhyme with the last line
D. It always states the theme directly

32. Which phrase is a symbol of hope in many contexts?

A. a small light in darkness
B. a locked empty box
C. a fading alarm
D. a cracked window

33. Which line has an end rhyme?

A. The sparks rose high
B. The logs were dry
C. The fire warmed the room
D. The fire glowed bright / Against the night

34. Which is the best definition of a refrain?

A. A line with no rhythm
B. A type of punctuation
C. A line or phrase repeated in a poem or song
D. A comparison between unlike things

35. Which word most strongly creates a gloomy mood?

A. playful
B. dreary
C. radiant
D. sparkling

36. Which line is literal rather than figurative?

A. The snow was a blanket
B. The snow covered the steps
C. The snow danced all night
D. The snow wore a white coat

37. Which phrase uses a comparison with “like” or “as”?

A. quiet as a mouse
B. the world is a stage
C. the angry wind
D. the road swallowed us

38. Which line appeals to hearing?

A. The apple was crisp
B. The candle smelled sweet
C. The stone felt cold
D. The kettle hissed on the stove

39. Which device exaggerates for effect?

A. Stanza
B. Imagery
C. Hyperbole
D. Rhyme

40. Which phrase is an example of personification?

A. The room had two windows
B. The shadows were long
C. The shadows crept across the wall
D. The wall was gray

Reading and Interpreting Poetic Choices

41. Which line most clearly communicates gratitude?

A. A bird rests on a branch
B. I carry your kindness like a lantern
C. The wind bends the grass
D. The road is made of stone

42. What is a poem's rhyme scheme?

A. The pattern of end rhymes
B. The poem's main character
C. The author's biography
D. The number of metaphors

43. Which word is closest in connotation to “frugal”?

A. eager to argue
B. easily frightened
C. careless with money
D. careful with money

44. Which line creates a sense of motion?

A. The room was square
B. The lamp was yellow
C. The bowl sat on the table
D. The stream raced over the rocks

45. Which phrase is a metaphor for sadness?

A. sad like rain
B. tears fell slowly
C. a storm inside my chest
D. I felt unhappy

46. Which line includes internal rhyme?

A. The tree stood alone
B. The bright light shone through the night
C. The birds sang at dawn
D. The clouds were gray

47. Which detail most strongly appeals to taste?

A. The tart berry stung my tongue
B. The wool scratched my wrist
C. The flowers smelled sweet
D. The bell rang loudly

48. Which is the best description of a poem's speaker?

A. The voice or persona presenting the words
B. Always the oldest character
C. The person who reads it aloud
D. Always the poet speaking as themself

49. Which line uses a simile to show speed?

A. The road swallowed him
B. He was a racing engine
C. His shoes were thunder
D. He ran like an arrow

50. Which feature can help create rhythm in a poem?

A. Only the title length
B. The font size
C. Patterns of stressed and unstressed syllables
D. The number of nouns

MEDIUM QUESTIONS (51–100)

Figurative Language and Comparison

51. Read: “The sidewalk swallowed the rain / while streetlights blinked awake.” Which device appears in both lines?

A. Understatement
B. Personification
C. Apostrophe
D. Exact rhyme

52. In “Her apology was a paper bridge,” what idea does the metaphor suggest?

A. The apology was written on paper
B. The apology may be fragile or insufficient
C. The apology was very loud
D. The speaker crossed a real bridge

53. A poem describes “the bitter taste of goodbye.” Which technique is most evident?

A. Sensory imagery used figuratively
B. End rhyme
C. Alliteration only
D. A literal recipe

54. Which statement best distinguishes tone from mood?

A. Tone is the rhyme pattern; mood is the line count
B. Tone and mood always mean exactly the same thing
C. Tone is the setting; mood is the speaker
D. Tone is the speaker's attitude; mood is the feeling created for readers

55. In a poem, the phrase “iron silence” most likely suggests—

A. a cheerful conversation
B. a metal instrument playing
C. a heavy, unbroken quiet
D. a noisy machine

56. Which is the strongest interpretation of a repeated line in a poem?

A. It always changes the speaker
B. It proves the poem has no theme
C. Its repetition may emphasize a central idea or feeling
D. It is repeated only to fill space

57. A poem's end words follow the pattern ABAB. What does this indicate?

A. All four lines rhyme
B. Lines 1 and 3 rhyme, and lines 2 and 4 rhyme
C. Only lines 1 and 2 rhyme
D. No lines rhyme

58. Which revision creates a more vivid image?

A. The cold rain needled my cheeks
B. It was raining outside
C. Rain happened that day
D. The weather was bad

59. Which line uses alliteration most clearly?

A. A bird crossed the sky
B. The night was quiet
C. The stars are far away
D. Silver snakes slide silently

60. A speaker calls a difficult day “a tiny hill.” What effect does this understatement create?

A. It creates a strict rhyme scheme
B. It describes a literal hill
C. It exaggerates the day into a disaster

D. It makes the difficulty sound smaller than it may be

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

61. In “The old house held its breath,” what is the likely effect of personification?

A. It proves the house is alive
B. It establishes a comic rhyme
C. It makes the house seem tense and watchful
D. It creates a factual description of breathing

62. Which detail most strongly contributes to an ominous mood?

A. Fresh bread cooled by the window
B. A door creaked open in the empty hall
C. Sunlight warmed the garden bench
D. Children laughed beside the fountain

63. A poem compares memories to “buttons in a jar.” Which interpretation is most plausible?

A. Memories are small, collected, and kept together
B. Memories are always made of metal
C. The speaker is shopping for clothes
D. The jar is the poem's setting only

64. Which line contains an example of consonance?

A. The blaNk taNk cluNked
B. The sun rose at dawn
C. A rose opened slowly
D. The owl flew away

65. A poet uses short, abrupt lines during a chase. What effect is most likely?

A. The poem's theme becomes obvious
B. The scene must feel calm
C. The lines prove the poem is a sonnet
D. The pace may feel quick and urgent

66. Which interpretation of “the city is a furnace” is strongest in a poem about summer?

A. The city has no buildings
B. The city is literally a factory furnace
C. The city feels intensely hot
D. The speaker is discussing winter

67. What does enjambment occur when—

A. two words begin with the same sound
B. a sentence or thought continues beyond the end of a poetic line
C. every line ends with a full stop
D. all lines have the same number of syllables

68. Which pair of words has the closest connotations?

A. radiant / gloomy
B. thrifty / economical
C. fragile / sturdy
D. reckless / cautious

69. A poem shifts from describing a storm to describing a calm morning. What should a reader examine?

A. How the shift changes the poem's mood or meaning
B. Whether the title is capitalized
C. The poet's handwriting
D. Only the number of letters in each word

70. Which line is an example of an extended metaphor beginning to develop?

A. The garden needs water
B. Questions were asked in class
C. My mind is busy today

D. My mind is a garden; each question plants a seed

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

71. A poem repeats “still I rise” after descriptions of setbacks. The repetition most strongly emphasizes—

A. the absence of a speaker
B. confusion about the setting
C. persistence and resilience
D. a change to past tense

72. Which feature is most useful when identifying a poem's rhythm aloud?

A. The author's age
B. The paper's color
C. The pattern of beats and stresses
D. The number of pages in the book

73. Which statement best explains symbolism?

A. Symbolism only occurs in the title
B. A concrete object can represent a larger idea
C. Every object must be interpreted literally
D. A symbol is always a rhyming word

74. A “rusted key” appears repeatedly in a poem about a family secret. What might it symbolize?

A. Access to something hidden or forgotten
B. A loud sound
C. The weather outside
D. A new beginning with no past

75. Which line uses assonance most clearly?

A. The dog barked twice
B. A bird sat still
C. The rain hit the roof
D. The slow road rolls home

76. Which interpretation best describes an ironic contrast?

A. The lifeguard wore a red shirt
B. The swimmer waved to a friend
C. The pool was twenty meters long
D. The lifeguard, afraid of water, refused to enter the pool

77. A poem has no regular end rhyme but still sounds musical. Which feature may help create that effect?

A. The absence of imagery
B. A list of dates
C. Rhythm, repetition, and sound patterns within lines
D. A mandatory ABAB pattern

78. Which phrase best uses a metaphor rather than a simile?

A. Hope burns as if it were fire
B. Hope is a candle in the dark
C. Hope shines like a candle
D. Hope is bright as a flame

79. The speaker describes a “golden cage.” What tension does this image suggest?

A. Comfort or beauty combined with confinement
B. A plain metal tool
C. A natural landscape with no barriers
D. Complete freedom without limits

80. Which question best helps a reader infer theme?

A. What insight about life emerges from the speaker's experience?
B. How many words are in the title?
C. Does every stanza have four lines?

D. Which letter appears most often?

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

81. Which line includes onomatopoeia and helps create a sharp sound?

A. Leaves covered the ground.
B. The tree stood beside the path.
C. The branch was old and dry.
D. Crack! The branch snapped underfoot.

82. What is the effect of a caesura in a poem?

A. A rhyme at the end of every stanza
B. A repeated opening consonant
C. A pause within a line that can shape emphasis or rhythm
D. A comparison using “like”

83. A speaker describes a lost toy with humor but ends in regret. What is the most likely effect?

A. The poem cannot have a theme
B. The tonal shift complicates the speaker's feelings
C. The mood remains identical throughout
D. The speaker must be unreliable

84. Which detail would best support an interpretation that a poem celebrates ordinary work?

A. A crown resting in an empty room
B. Hands rough from planting, baking, and building
C. A storm destroying a bridge
D. A locked door with no one nearby

85. A poem's title is “After the Applause,” and the speaker describes an empty stage. Which inference is strongest?

A. It may explore what remains after public praise ends
B. It has no connection to the poem's meaning
C. It must be about a sports injury
D. It only describes stage lighting

86. Which phrase uses a mixed metaphor?

A. The plan grew slowly
B. The idea took root
C. The ship sailed at dawn
D. We must nip this problem in the bud before it sails

87. Why might a poet choose free verse?

A. To ensure every line rhymes
B. To make every stanza the same length
C. To shape rhythm and line breaks without a fixed traditional pattern
D. To avoid using imagery

88. Which line most clearly creates a contrast through juxtaposition?

A. The child walked along the road
B. The wall was made of brick
C. A child laughed beside the ruined wall
D. The day ended at sunset

89. A poem's speaker says, “I praise the storm that broke my roof.” What should readers consider?

A. Whether the roof is the poem's only symbol
B. Whether the statement is ironic or reveals an unexpected viewpoint
C. Whether praise must be literal
D. Whether all storms are helpful

90. Which is the strongest way to support an interpretation of a poem?

A. Cite specific words or lines and explain how they support the reading
B. Guess the poet's private intention as fact
C. Summarize the title only

D. State a personal reaction without details

Reading and Interpreting Poetic Choices

91. Which sound device repeats vowel sounds in nearby words?

A. Onomatopoeia
B. End rhyme
C. Alliteration
D. Assonance

92. What can a change in line length contribute to?

A. The number of characters in a story
B. Only the poem's publication date
C. A guaranteed change in speaker
D. Pacing, emphasis, or the shape of an idea

93. A poem describes “winter in my heart” after a friendship ends. The phrase most likely represents—

A. a cheerful celebration
B. a literal change in body temperature
C. emotional coldness or sadness
D. the poem's geographic location

94. Which line most clearly uses a paradox?

A. The bird flew over the fence
B. The more I learned, the less I knew
C. The rain fell on the roof
D. The lamp glowed in the room

95. What is the likely purpose of a volta, or turn, in a poem?

A. To mark a shift in thought, feeling, or argument
B. To make all lines the same length
C. To remove the speaker
D. To repeat the title at random

96. Which interpretation is best supported by a poem where a seed survives a harsh winter and blooms in spring?

A. Renewal can follow a difficult period
B. All plants grow without sunlight
C. Winter lasts forever
D. The speaker dislikes flowers

97. A poet places a long pause before the final word of a line. What might this emphasize?

A. The author's location
B. The number of stanzas
C. The title's spelling
D. The final word's meaning or emotional weight

98. Which phrase most clearly conveys ambivalence?

A. I felt only anger
B. I was completely delighted
C. I missed the freedom, but feared the open road
D. I had no doubts at all

99. A poem's recurring image changes from a closed window to an open one. What might this progression suggest?

A. A fixed meaning with no development
B. A movement from isolation toward possibility
C. A change in the poem's author
D. A shift from summer to winter only

100. A poem shifts from first-person singular to collective “we.” Which question best guides interpretation?

A. Does it remove the poem's subject?
B. Does the shift suggest a change from private experience to shared identity?
C. Does it prove every reader agrees with the speaker?

D. Does it guarantee that the poem rhymes?

HARD QUESTIONS (101–150)

Figurative Language and Comparison

101. Read the original lines: “I stitched the dawn to yesterday / and wore the seam beneath my coat.” Which interpretation is best supported?

A. The speaker carries the past into a new beginning
B. The poem is only about clothing
C. The speaker is literally sewing the sky
D. The speaker has forgotten yesterday

102. A poem describes a “bright darkness” surrounding a character who feels both relieved and afraid. This phrase is best understood as—

A. an example of onomatopoeia
B. a literal description of lighting
C. an end-rhyme pattern
D. a paradox that captures mixed emotions

103. A poet repeatedly uses images of clocks, deadlines, and shrinking shadows. Which interpretation is most strongly supported?

A. The speaker is definitely a clockmaker
B. The poem is mainly about gardening
C. The poem may emphasize time pressure or mortality
D. The images prove the poem is humorous

104. In a poem, a bird is first described behind glass and later flying over the sea. What is the strongest interpretation of this symbolic development?

A. It proves the bird changes species
B. It means the speaker dislikes the sea
C. It may represent movement from restriction to freedom
D. It only shows a change in weather

105. A poem's speaker praises a leader while describing the leader's cruelty through exaggerated compliments. Which device is most likely at work?

A. Literal praise only
B. Verbal irony
C. Assonance alone
D. A simple simile

106. Which analysis best explains how enjambment can affect meaning?

A. It can carry a thought across a line break, delaying completion or shifting emphasis
B. It always creates a perfect rhyme
C. It removes all pauses from a poem
D. It makes every line a complete sentence

107. A poem uses a steady rhythm during a routine task, then breaks the rhythm as the speaker receives bad news. What does the shift most likely accomplish?

A. It proves the poem has no structure
B. It adds an unrelated sound effect
C. It guarantees a comic mood
D. It formally mirrors the disruption in the speaker's experience

108. Which interpretation best distinguishes a symbol from a motif?

A. They are identical terms in every context
B. A symbol must repeat; a motif appears only once
C. A symbol is always a person; a motif is always a place
D. A symbol carries meaning beyond itself; a motif is a recurring element that may develop meaning

109. A poem about migration repeats images of suitcases, thresholds, and maps. How should a reader analyze the pattern?

A. Assume the poem is a travel advertisement
B. Treat each object as unrelated decoration

C. Consider how the recurring images build ideas about departure, transition, and belonging
D. Count the images without interpreting them

110. Which claim about a poem is best supported by textual evidence?

A. The poet definitely wrote this after a specific private argument
B. The repeated broken-wing image suggests vulnerability because it appears when the speaker describes loss
C. The title alone proves the entire theme
D. The poem means whatever each reader first guesses

Imagery, Mood, Tone, and Connotation

111. A poem begins with clipped, short phrases and ends with long flowing lines after the speaker forgives a friend. What is the most plausible effect?

A. The changing syntax may reflect a release of tension
B. The structure is unrelated to the poem's meaning
C. The longer lines prove the poem is a limerick
D. The change means the speaker has stopped speaking

112. A poem describes a “museum of unsent words.” Which interpretation best accounts for the metaphor?

A. Unspoken thoughts are being preserved and revisited
B. The speaker works in a real museum, necessarily
C. The words have literally become paintings
D. The speaker has no memories

113. Which evidence would best support the interpretation that the speaker is unreliable?

A. The title contains a noun
B. The poem has four stanzas
C. The speaker uses a first-person pronoun
D. The speaker's confident claims conflict with details the poem reveals

114. A poet uses a traditional rhyme scheme to describe a chaotic argument. What is a careful interpretation of this contrast?

A. The form proves the argument never happened
B. The rhyme scheme has no possible effect
C. The controlled form may contrast with the disorder being described
D. Traditional rhyme always creates a happy mood

115. Which statement best analyzes an ambiguous ending?

A. It proves the poem has no meaning
B. It leaves more than one plausible interpretation, shaped by earlier images and conflicts
C. It can only be interpreted using the author's biography
D. It means the writer forgot to finish

116. The phrase “the crown weighed less than the promise” appears in a poem about leadership. What contrast does it most likely create?

A. The poem has no figurative language
B. The burden of responsibility may matter more than status
C. A crown is physically lighter than every promise
D. The speaker is only describing jewelry

117. Which revision most effectively strengthens the imagery without making the line overloaded?

A. The frost silvered the grass at dawn
B. The grass was there in the morning
C. The grass had a quality that was noticeable
D. The very extremely cold and frosty grass was silver and icy and white

118. A poet places the word “alone” on a line by itself after several crowded lines. What is the most likely effect?

A. The word is no longer part of the poem
B. The poem must be a sonnet
C. The stanza's rhyme scheme is automatically ABAB
D. Isolation receives visual and rhythmic emphasis

119. Which reading best accounts for an image that is both beautiful and threatening, such as “roses with sharpened thorns”?

A. The image only describes gardening
B. The speaker is certainly cheerful
C. The image combines attraction with danger
D. The roses must be artificial

120. A poem repeatedly addresses the sea as “you,” but the sea never responds. What technique is present?

A. A flashback
B. An exact rhyme scheme
C. Apostrophe, addressing an absent or nonhuman subject
D. A literal dialogue between two people

Sound, Rhythm, Rhyme, and Structure

121. Which statement best explains how sound can reinforce meaning?

A. Every poem must use the same sound device
B. Harsh consonants may intensify a scene of conflict when they cluster around violent actions
C. Rhyme always contradicts the subject
D. Sound patterns never affect interpretation

122. A poem's title seems cheerful, but the final stanza reveals grief. What should a reader do?

A. Reconsider how the title's apparent optimism functions in light of the ending
B. Conclude that the poem has no mood
C. Assume the title is unrelated
D. Ignore the final stanza

123. Which option best explains the difference between a poem's subject and theme?

A. The subject is always the title; the theme is always the final word
B. The subject is the rhyme scheme; the theme is the stanza count
C. They are interchangeable in all analyses
D. The subject is what it is about; the theme is an insight developed about that subject

124. A poem juxtaposes a wedding bell with a hospital monitor's beep. What might this contrast emphasize?

A. That all sound imagery is literal
B. That the poem has no central idea
C. That the two sounds are identical
D. The closeness of celebration and vulnerability in human life

125. A speaker says, “I buried my anger, but it grew roots.” Which interpretation best captures the metaphor's development?

A. The anger has disappeared permanently
B. The speaker is describing gardening only
C. Suppressed anger may persist and become more deeply established
D. The roots prove the speaker is outdoors

126. Which analysis of a recurring color is most responsible?

A. Ignore how the color changes across stanzas
B. Track where the color appears and infer its meaning from context and change
C. Assume the poet chose it randomly
D. Assign it one universal meaning without reading the poem

127. A poem shifts from “we” to “I” near its conclusion. What should the reader investigate?

A. Whether the shift changes the speaker's sense of community or personal responsibility
B. Whether the shift is automatically an error
C. Whether the poet changed their legal name
D. Whether the poem has a rhyme scheme

128. Which is the strongest interpretation of a deliberate break in a familiar rhyme pattern at the poem's climax?

A. The disruption may signal emotional or thematic change
B. It proves the poet cannot rhyme
C. It has no effect if the poem has a title
D. It always means the poem is unfinished

129. A poem describes a locked gate throughout, then ends with “I stopped searching for the key.” What is a plausible inference?

A. The poem is only about home repair
B. The gate has definitely disappeared
C. The speaker has found the key
D. The speaker may be changing their relationship to an obstacle rather than overcoming it directly

130. Which evidence best supports a claim that a poem critiques consumerism?

A. The fact that the poem contains a metaphor
B. The author's name on the cover
C. Repeated images of price tags, disposable objects, and people treated as products
D. One mention of a shopping bag with no further context

Symbolism, Theme, and Interpretation

131. A poem uses a lullaby-like rhythm while describing an unsettling event. What effect can this mismatch create?

A. A shift to factual prose
B. An eerie contrast between soothing form and disturbing content
C. A complete absence of mood
D. A guarantee that the event is harmless

132. Which interpretation is most careful when a poem includes a mythological allusion?

A. Ignore the surrounding lines
B. Use the allusion's relevant associations and the poem's context to explain its effect
C. Treat the allusion as proof the poem is ancient
D. Assume every reader must know the myth already

133. A poem's speaker repeatedly corrects their own statements. What effect might this self-correction create?

A. It may reveal uncertainty, conflict, or a mind revising its understanding
B. It creates end rhyme automatically
C. It proves the poem has no structure
D. It means the speaker is not present

134. Which line creates the most layered metaphor for memory?

A. The beach was wide
B. The shells were small
C. I remember the beach
D. Memory is a tide that returns with altered shells

135. A poet uses an abrupt dash before a confession. Which interpretation is best?

A. The dash creates a rhyme scheme
B. The punctuation must be accidental
C. The pause may dramatize hesitation or a sudden change in thought
D. The dash proves the confession is false

136. Which approach best evaluates whether a poem's form supports its theme?

A. Focus only on the poet's biography
B. Assume form and meaning are unrelated
C. Examine how structure, rhythm, line breaks, and sound interact with the ideas
D. Count the words and stop there

137. A poem describes a city as “a thousand separate windows, each holding a different moon.” What idea does this image most strongly suggest?

A. The speaker is giving an architectural report
B. People may share a place while experiencing distinct private worlds
C. Every window contains a literal moon
D. The city has no inhabitants

138. Which reading best handles a poem with conflicting images of both departure and return?

A. The poem may explore a complicated relationship with home or belonging
B. One of the images must be a mistake
C. The title alone settles the conflict

D. The poem can have only one literal meaning

139. Which line most clearly uses metonymy, referring to an institution through something associated with it?

A. The crown was made of gold
B. The king wore a crown
C. A crown fell from the shelf
D. The crown announced a new law

140. A poem's speaker describes silence as “a room we built together.” What does the metaphor imply?

A. The speaker is an architect
B. The room must be empty
C. Silence is literally a building
D. Silence may be a shared condition created by more than one person

Reading and Interpreting Poetic Choices

141. Which claim is strongest when interpreting a complex poem?

A. The poem is definitely about one specific real person
B. The first image determines every later meaning
C. The repeated doorway images suggest choices, supported by the speaker's hesitation at each threshold
D. The poem means sadness because it feels sad to me

142. A poem's final image transforms a recurring symbol rather than resolving it. What effect can this have?

A. It proves the poem lacks an ending
B. It invites readers to reinterpret the symbol and the poem's earlier moments
C. It makes interpretation impossible
D. It removes all connection to the earlier stanzas

143. Which statement best analyzes an effective poetic ambiguity?

A. The wording supports multiple readings that remain connected to the poem's details
B. Any interpretation is equally supported
C. Ambiguity means the poem has no theme
D. The words are unclear, so no interpretation is possible

144. A poem uses the image of a compass that spins whenever the speaker must choose. What does the recurring image most likely represent?

A. Difficulty finding direction or certainty
B. A reliable sense of purpose
C. A literal weather forecast
D. A completed journey

145. Which approach best compares two poems about grief?

A. Decide which is sadder without evidence
B. Compare only their titles
C. Assume they communicate the same message because of the subject
D. Compare their imagery, speakers, tone, structure, and conclusions using details from both

146. A poem describes “the silence after the last note” as “another kind of music.” What does this paradox suggest?

A. Silence literally produces musical notes
B. The speaker dislikes music
C. Absence or quiet can still carry emotional meaning
D. The poem has no sound imagery

147. Which is the most convincing analysis of a poem's final turn?

A. Restate the last line without interpretation
B. Explain how the shift revises or complicates ideas established earlier
C. Ignore the earlier stanzas
D. Assume every final line is the theme

148. A poet describes a bridge as “half promise, half warning.” Which interpretation best preserves the tension?

A. The speaker has no mixed feelings
B. The bridge may offer connection while also presenting risk

C. The image means that all journeys are safe
D. The bridge is only a physical structure

149. A poem describes a cracked mirror whenever the speaker remembers childhood. What is the most careful interpretation?

A. The mirror may suggest a fractured or changing sense of identity, if supported by the surrounding lines
B. The mirror always symbolizes vanity in every poem
C. The speaker must work as a glassmaker
D. The image is unrelated to memory by definition

150. Two plausible interpretations of a poem differ. What is the best way to decide which is better supported?

A. Decide based only on the poem's title
B. Assume the first interpretation is always correct
C. Choose the interpretation with the most dramatic wording
D. Compare each interpretation with the poem's language, structure, and recurring patterns

ANSWER KEY

Topic 5: Poetry, Figurative Language, and Literary Devices

Questions 1–50: Easy • 51–100: Medium • 101–150: Hard

1	D	31	A	61	C	91	D	121	B
2	C	32	A	62	B	92	D	122	A
3	B	33	D	63	A	93	C	123	D
4	B	34	C	64	A	94	B	124	D
5	A	35	B	65	D	95	A	125	C
6	D	36	B	66	C	96	A	126	B
7	C	37	A	67	B	97	D	127	A
8	C	38	D	68	B	98	C	128	A
9	B	39	C	69	A	99	B	129	D
10	A	40	C	70	D	100	B	130	C
11	D	41	B	71	C	101	A	131	B
12	D	42	A	72	C	102	D	132	B
13	C	43	D	73	B	103	C	133	A
14	B	44	D	74	A	104	C	134	D
15	A	45	C	75	D	105	B	135	C
16	A	46	B	76	D	106	A	136	C
17	D	47	A	77	C	107	D	137	B
18	C	48	A	78	B	108	D	138	A
19	B	49	D	79	A	109	C	139	D
20	B	50	C	80	A	110	B	140	D
21	A	51	B	81	D	111	A	141	C
22	D	52	B	82	C	112	A	142	B
23	C	53	A	83	B	113	D	143	A
24	C	54	D	84	B	114	C	144	A
25	B	55	C	85	A	115	B	145	D
26	A	56	C	86	D	116	B	146	C
27	D	57	B	87	C	117	A	147	B
28	D	58	A	88	C	118	D	148	B
29	C	59	D	89	B	119	C	149	A
30	B	60	D	90	A	120	C	150	D